

# Phase8 Daily Schedule

## Phase 8 — Day-by-Day Schedule · Research + Big-Tech Interview Crescendo

Weeks 70-75 · Mon Jan 3 → Sun Feb 13, 2028 · ~160 hrs · → Tier 3

**Goal:** convert the whole plan into offers. RE loop = 2 medium-hard coding + ML fundamentals + ML system design + behavioral (+ a research discussion for research roles). **Research loops ban AI tools — rehearse everything unaided.**

Blocks: **A** 06-08 (theory/whiteboard) · **B** 08:30-10:30 (timed coding + implement) · **Evening** 20:30-22:30 (behavioral, mocks, R). Weekend = buffer + rest + live mocks. Threads T/M/R now fold into interview prep; **R** carries your live application loops.

### Week 70 · Jan 3-9 — DSA at RE weight (timed)

| Day     | Block A                                  | Block B (timed)                 | Evening (+ R)                               |
|---------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Mon     | Patterns: two-pointer, sliding window    | 4-6 timed mediums (35 min each) | Review misses; <b>R:</b> schedule loops     |
| Tue     | Trees, graphs, BFS/DFS                   | 4-6 timed, blank editor         | Review; Anki                                |
| Wed     | DP patterns                              | 4-6 timed                       | Review                                      |
| Thu     | Heaps, intervals, greedy                 | 4-6 timed                       | <b>R:</b> applications                      |
| Fri     | Backtracking; tricky mediums             | Mixed timed set                 | Whiteboard-Fri: explain 2 solutions cleanly |
| Sat-Sun | <b>Buffer + rest</b> · a couple of hards |                                 |                                             |

### Week 71 · Jan 10-16 — DSA cont (company-tagged) + hards

| Day     | Block A                                                    | Block B (timed)               | Evening (+ R)                            |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Mon     | Company-tagged set (target labs)                           | Timed set; blank editor, runs | <b>R:</b> loops                          |
| Tue     | Graphs/DP hards                                            | Timed hards (~45 min)         | Review                                   |
| Wed     | Strings, tries                                             | Timed set                     | Anki                                     |
| Thu     | Math/bit/heap mix                                          | Timed set                     | <b>R:</b> applications                   |
| Fri     | Weak-area drill                                            | Timed set                     | Whiteboard-Fri: a hard in ~45 min, clean |
| Sat-Sun | <b>Buffer + rest</b> · live mock (Pramp / interviewing.io) |                               |                                          |

### Week 72 · Jan 17-23 — Implement-from-scratch ML (unaided, timed)

| Day     | Block A                                 | Block B (blank file, timed)                      | Evening (+ R)                            |
|---------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Mon     | ML-math sweep (gradients, KL, sampling) | Implement backprop through an MLP                | <b>R:</b> loops                          |
| Tue     | Attention refresh                       | Implement multi-head attention (+ $\sqrt{d_k}$ ) | Review                                   |
| Wed     | Losses refresh                          | Implement a domain loss (Dice/Focal)             | Anki                                     |
| Thu     | Sampling & diffusion                    | Implement a sampler + a DDPM step                | <b>R:</b> applications                   |
| Fri     | GNN refresh                             | Implement a message-passing layer                | Whiteboard-Fri: all above unaided, timed |
| Sat-Sun | <b>Buffer + rest</b> · live mock        |                                                  |                                          |

### Week 73 · Jan 24-30 — ML system design

| Day | Block A                              | Block B                                             | Evening (+ R)          |
|-----|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Mon | Chip Huyen: ML system design framing | Prompt 1: molecular-property serving system         | <b>R:</b> loops        |
| Tue | Data/feature/model/serving layers    | Prompt 2: virtual-screening pipeline (billion-cmpd) | Review recording       |
| Wed | Monitoring, drift, retraining        | Prompt 3: imaging pipeline w/ domain shift          | Anki                   |
| Thu | Generic system design (ByteByteGo)   | Prompt 4: HCP RAG assistant at scale                | <b>R:</b> applications |

|         |                           |                                     |                                      |
|---------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Fri     | Trade-off articulation    | Prompt 5 (self-critiqued, recorded) | Whiteboard-Fri: a full 45-min design |
| Sat-Sun | Buffer + rest · live mock |                                     |                                      |

Week 74 · Jan 31-Feb 6 — System design cont + research job-talk prep

| Day     | Block A                                    | Block B                                   | Evening (+ R)                                         |
|---------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Mon     | More design prompts (recorded)             | Refine designs; low-level/OO where needed | R: loops                                              |
| Tue     | Build the imaging-flagship talk (20 min)   | Slides + Q&A anticipation                 | Rehearse                                              |
| Wed     | Build the molecular/physics-capstone talk  | Slides + Q&A                              | Rehearse                                              |
| Thu     | Paper-discussion prep (for research loops) | Deep-read 2 target-lab papers             | R: applications                                       |
| Fri     | Talk dry-run (record)                      | Iterate on feedback                       | Whiteboard-Fri: defend a design choice under pushback |
| Sat-Sun | Buffer + rest · mock job-talk to a peer    |                                           |                                                       |

Week 75 · Feb 7-13 — Behavioral + mocks + self-test

| Day     | Block A                                                                                                                                                            | Block B                 | Evening (+ R)            |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| Mon     | STAR stories (6-8 per org)                                                                                                                                         | Full mock loop (coding) | R: loops                 |
| Tue     | "Why digital biology / why me" narrative                                                                                                                           | Mock: ML fundamentals   | Refine stories           |
| Wed     | Behavioral depth (conflict, leadership)                                                                                                                            | Mock: ML system design  | Anki                     |
| Thu     | Research discussion mock                                                                                                                                           | Mock: job-talk + Q&A    | R: applications          |
| Fri     | ► PHASE-8 SELF-TEST (hard in ~45 min clean; implement attention+loss+sampler+GNN unaided/timed; 45-min system-design; 20-min job-talk; 4 STAR stories from memory) | Final mixed mock        | ► Tier-3 loops in flight |
| Sat-Sun | Buffer + rest · intensive interviewing                                                                                                                             |                         |                          |

End of Phase 8 → Phase Q (Quantum/QML) next — concentrated after the crescendo; interview in parallel.